

Guideline Title: Asystole and Pulseless Electrical Activity

Guideline Number: GUID-3203-C002

Issue date: 09/09/2014	Replaces Dept. Policy:
Revision dates: 4/30/24	Developed by: Air Care Team
Approved by: Dr. Christopher Hunter, MD Air Care Team Medical Director	Approved by:
Signature: 	Signature
Department Numbers: 3203	

- I. **PURPOSE:** Successful treatment of asystole/PEA with a return of spontaneous circulation
- II. **DEFINITIONS:**
 - a. PEA – Pulseless Electrical Activity
 - b. CPR – Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation
- III. **DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:**
 - A. Initiate CPR per American Heart Association (AHA) guideline, administer oxygen, apply ETCO2 monitor if advanced airway present, and maintain ETCO2 > 10 mmHg.
 - i. If available, an FDA approved cardiac compression/mechanical CPR device may be applied and utilized per manufacturer's instructions
 - B. Apply cardiac monitor, confirm rhythm in two leads. Perform rhythm analysis every 2 minutes between cycles of CPR.
 - C. Consider possible causes and treat accordingly. ("H's and T's: Hypovolemia, Hypoxia, Hypo/hyperkalemia, Hypoglycemia, Hypothermia, Acidosis, Drug Overdose, Cardiac Tamponade, Tension Pneumothorax, Thrombosis, Trauma, and Toxins).
 - D. Establish IV/IO access.
 - E. Administer the following medication:
 - i. **Epinephrine (1:10,000) 1 mg IV/IO push**, repeat every 3-5 minutes.
 - F. Secure airway and ventilate with 100% oxygen. Avoid hyperventilation.
 - G. Consider the administration of blood products for traumatic arrest. Refer to *GUID3203-PR025 Emergency Uncrossmatched Blood Product Administration*.
 - H. Consider **Sodium Bicarbonate 1 mEq/kg IV/IO push** for suspected tricyclic antidepressant overdose, suspected hyperkalemia, or end-stage renal disease
 - I. Administer correct treatment for suspected drug overdoses per *GUID3203-M019 Toxic Ingestion/Exposure*.
 - J. If ROSC is achieved prior to interfacility transfer and the patient previously had a rhythm that was defibrillated, consult with physician regarding targeted temperature management per *GUID3203-C009 Target Temperature Management*.
 - K. Always consider the latest recommendations from the AHA

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- IV. **DOCUMENTATION:** EMS CHARTS
- V. **REFERENCES:** American Heart Association Guidelines, 2015.